

Indicate Institutional Address on letterhead

Date

International Society for Vaccines 2024 ISV ECR Travel Award

To The ECR Travel Award Committee:

I am excited to support Dr Susan Smith as an applicant for the ISV 2024 ECR Travel Award. Susan has been a post-doctoral researcher in my laboratory since June 2019. She is now a senior post-doctoral researcher in excellent standing in our program and both she and the scientific community at ISV would benefit from her in-person participation at ISV 2024.

Susan's strong background in virology, molecular biology, and immune function assays made her an ideal fit for the lab. She has been an exciting addition that has helped push forward our research on DNA vaccines and DNA-encoded molecular adjuvants for various diseases, including cytokine dysregulations found in cancer biology, and SARS-CoV-2 vaccines.

Susan has distinguished herself by her research and scholarly accomplishments. She previously completed two full years of NIH NRSA T32 funding in Cancer Biology. She has authored several important studies since joining our lab including the first demonstration that gene-delivered cytokine adjuvants administered parenterally can induce robust, heterologous protection at mucosal surfaces in the context of SARS-CoV-2 vaccines. More recently, she reported that gene delivery of the enzyme adenosine deaminase in the context of SARS-CoV-2 DNA vaccines can support robust, broad, long-lived humoral immunity, which is protective in aged mouse models of SARS-CoV-2 infection. She will be presenting further exciting data, including challenge results at this meeting. Additionally, she is serving as the lead scientist on an industry-sponsored collaboration focused on developing RNA-based vaccines and biologics targeting rabies. These projects will provide her with valuable experience in translational research and the intricacies of corporate collaborations and government-funded contract research.

Attending the ISV annual congress is an important part of her annual training. This year's congress in South Korea will be especially important for her as sessions focused on generating B cell memory with vaccination will relate directly to her future research program which will focus on discovering immune mechanisms to engender long-lived, protective, humoral immunity in the aged via vaccination.

Thank you for your consideration of this applicant and I hope you will strongly consider the impact this award will have on her career.

Best regards,

Indicate name

Indicate rank and Institutional affiliation.

Indicate address/ contact details.

Signature and Date